Lifespans of the U.S. Presidents

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In the results, I found that Jimmy Carter, George Bush, and Gerald Ford were the top three longest lived presidents, while on the other side, John F. Kennedy, James A. Garfield, and James K. Polk were the shortest lived. The average lifespan of U.S. presidents is 72.82 years, and connecting back to the minimum and maximum lifespans of US Presidents, Jimmy Carter lived to 100 while JFK lived to 46.

Figure 1: Histogram of U.S. Presidents' Lifespans

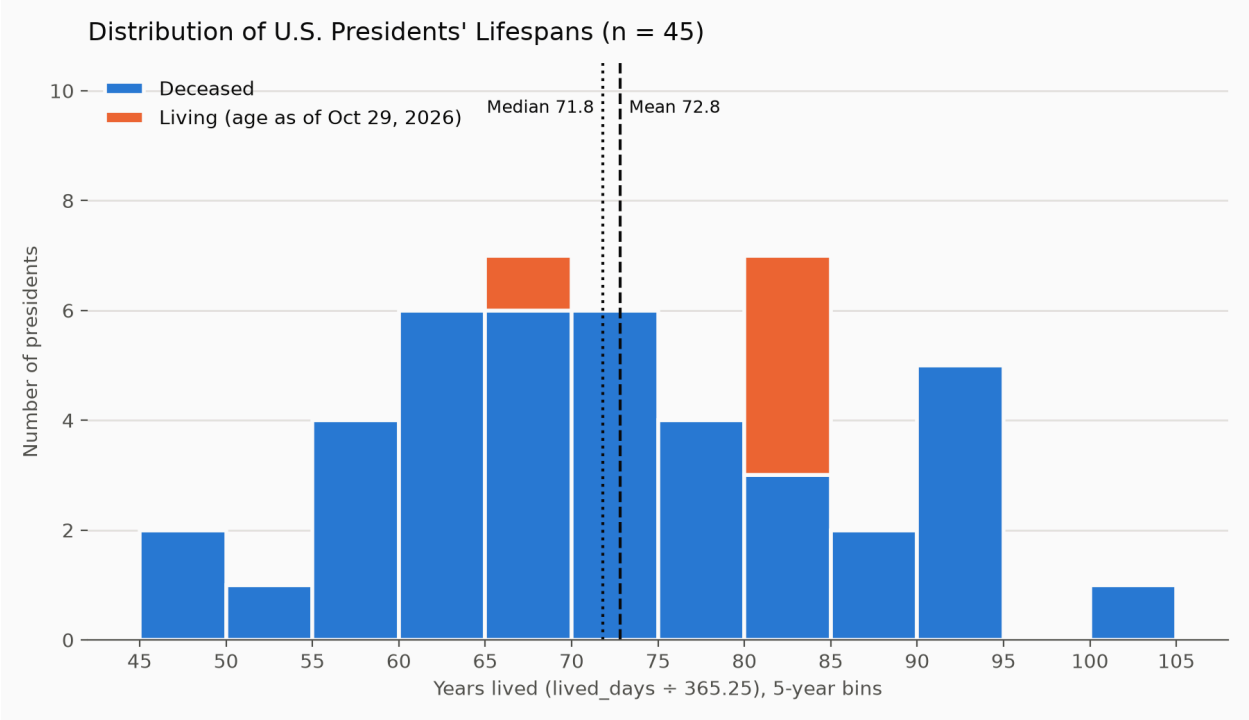


Table 1: Top 10 Longest-Lived Presidents

Rank	President	year_of_birth	lived_years	lived_months	lived_days	Status
1	Jimmy Carter	1924	100.24	1,202.9	36,614	Deceased
2	George Bush	1924	94.47	1,133.6	34,504	Deceased
3	Gerald Ford	1913	93.45	1,121.4	34,133	Deceased
4	Ronald Reagan	1911	93.33	1,119.9	34,088	Deceased
5	John Adams	1735	90.67	1,088.1	33,119	Deceased

Rank	President	year_of_birth	lived_years	lived_months	lived_days	Status
6	Herbert Hoover	1874	90.19	1,082.3	32,943	Deceased
7	Harry S. Truman	1884	88.63	1,063.6	32,373	Deceased
8	James Madison	1751	85.28	1,023.4	31,150	Deceased
9	Joe Biden	1942	83.94	1,007.3	30,659	Living
10	Thomas Jefferson	1743	83.22	998.7	30,397	Deceased

Living presidents are measured to October 29, 2026.

Table 2: Top 10 Shortest-Lived Presidents

Rank	President	year_of_birth	lived_years	lived_months	lived days	Status
1	John F. Kennedy	1917	46.48	557.8	16,978	Deceased
2	James A. Garfield	1831	49.83	598.0	18,202	Deceased
3	James K. Polk	1795	53.62	643.4	19,583	Deceased
4	Abraham Lincoln	1809	56.17	674.0	20,516	Deceased
5	Chester Arthur	1829	57.12	685.4	20,863	Deceased
6	Warren G. Harding	1865	57.74	692.9	21,091	Deceased
7	William McKinley	1843	58.62	703.5	21,412	Deceased
8	Theodore Roosevelt	1858	60.19	722.3	21,985	Deceased
9	Calvin Coolidge	1872	60.50	726.0	22,099	Deceased
10	Franklin Roosevelt	1882	63.20	758.3	23,082	Deceased

Table 3: Summary Statistics of lived_days

Statistic	lived_days	In years
Mean	26,597.2	72.82
Weighted average	26,643.8	72.95
Median	26,227	71.81
Mode	None (all values unique)	—

Statistic	lived_days	In years
Maximum	36,614	100.24
Minimum	16,978	46.48
Standard deviation	4,617.2	12.64

Weighted by presidencies held (2 for Grover Cleveland and Donald Trump, 1 for all others). Standard deviation is the population version (all 45 presidents).

Comments and Assumptions:

- Living presidents are measured to October 29, 2026.
- Source data comes from 2021 so Carter's December 29, 2024 passing was added
- Months were detailed as July but also Sep so date-parsing had to be accounted for, because July is spelled out but Sep is short-hand. Pandas blanked on 6 birth dates so I had to parse with format = "mixed" and checked with assertions.
- The weighted average is weighted by how many presidencies they served, because the only presidents to serve non-consecutive terms are Grover Cleveland and Trump. If I had extra data I would be interested in seeing if there is any correlation between time in office and life expectancy.
- The standard deviation is the population version because all presidents are included
- I selected a histogram because it shows the full shape of one variable so I could cluster years together and show how spread they are, and where the outliers lie. 5-year bins read naturally as age ranges, with living vs deceased presidents in separate colors. The x-axis is scaled to read in years.
- No two presidents lived the same number of days, so there is no mode.
- The figures are provisional because five presidents are still living today.

Conclusion

The shortest lifespans were cut short by events, not age. Four of the seven shortest-lived presidents were assassinated, including JFK, the single shortest-lived. Additionally, recent presidents tend to live longer, the top four were born between 1911 and 1924, and 8 of the 10 shortest-lived were born in the 1800s.